

OpenSpec vs orgspec — Feature Comparison

orgspec (issue #5) is an org-native, dependency-free Emacs Lisp port of OpenSpec's load-bearing core. Complete: MVP (#29), slash commands (#30), agenda lifecycle + typed MCP tools (#31), native session picker, fold review (#37), and the hard-gate validator (#38). Issue #5 and every split follow-up are closed.

Substrate

	OpenSpec	orgspec
Language	TypeScript (~33k lines)	Emacs Lisp (~1k lines)
Runtime dep	npm / Node	none (org-element)
Format	Markdown	org-native
Delta marker	## ADDED headers	org tags :ADDED: / ... + :AREA:
Artifacts/change	4 files	1 change.org
Execution	headless CLI	running Emacs + mcp-emacs

Workflow — shipped

Verb	orgspec	Notes
propose	/orgspec:propose	scaffold + draft the whole change.org
new	/orgspec:new	mkdir + template
apply	/orgspec:apply	implement tasks, tick boxes, advance TODO lifecycle
status	/orgspec:status	[x] / [] counts
parse	/orgspec:parse	delta as structured data
validate	/orgspec:validate	hard-gate ERROR rules; the gate archive/review enforce
review	/orgspec:review	ediff the fold against current specs before writing — see it, don't trust it
archive	/orgspec:archive	fold delta into specs/ (RENAMED->REMOVED->MODIFIED->ADDED) + git mv

All are also typed `orgspec_*` MCP tools (eight, registered via a server extra-tools hook), not just the raw `eval` shortcut.

Fold engine (the load-bearing port)

Fixed order RENAMED->REMOVED->MODIFIED->ADDED · subtree surgery, not text splice · validate-all-then-write-all (a late failure leaves specs/ untouched) · MODIFIED scenario drop-guard · re-level strips TODO + op-tag + :AREA:, keeps :IMPL:.

Org leverage — the “why Emacs, not a CLI” payoff

Feature	Status
Agenda TODO lifecycle (in-flight dashboard from the user’s own keywords)	shipped
ediff fold review (see the fold before it writes)	shipped (#37)
Req<->code :IMPL: writer	won’t-do — rot risk vs thin solo payoff; fold still preserves a hand-written drawer

Dropped

- **Won’t-do:** the :IMPL: req<->code traceability writer (rot risk vs thin solo-scale payoff; the fold still preserves a hand-written drawer).
- **Out of scope for solo work:** explore, continue, ff (subsumed by propose), update, sync (folded into archive), bulk-archive, onboard.

Nothing is open: the validator (`orgspec-validate.el`) and the ediff fold review both shipped.

Fallback: if CI-enforced validation, many conflicting parallel changes, or team-enforced structure ever become the requirement, revert to OpenSpec proper.